

Rubai Mushtaq

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Currently in my second year at Ashoka University, I am a Biology major with a minor in Mathematics. During the past year, I have had the opportunity to really dive into evolutionary immunology and the physics of cellular functions, coupled with mathematical modelling. It was during this period of exploration that I developed an interest in dynamical living systems. Whether it's host-pathogen interactions, infection dynamics, or the perturbations of cellular functions, I hope to study these complex dynamics across all scales.

EDUCATION

Ashoka University

- **Duration:** August 2024 - May 2028
- **Major:** Biology
- **Minor:** Mathematics
- **CGPA:** 3.82
- **Major CGPA:** 3.90
- **Dean's List:** Monsoon 2024, Spring 2025, Monsoon 2025, Spring 2026

DriveChange Learning & Resource Centre (DLRC)

- **Duration:** May 2022 - March 2024
- **Board:** Cambridge International AS and A Levels.
- **A Levels Final Grades:** Mathematics: A*, Physics: A*, Chemistry: A*, Biology: A*.

Vidya Valley School

- **Duration:** June 2012 - May 2022
- **Board:** Council for the Indian School Certificate Examinations
- **FINAL SCORE (GRADE 10, ICSE): 98.2%**

CLUBS AND ACTIVITIES

The Biology Society at Ashoka University

- **Role and Duration:** Head of Events (August 2025 - May 2026)

Student Government

- **Role and Duration:** Head Girl at Vidya Valley School (June 2021 - May 2022).

EXPERIENCE

NIUS Fellow | IISER Pune

- **Duration:** June 2025 - August 2025
- **Selection:** Out of around 40 participants at NIUS's Biology Camp, approximately 10 of us were selected to pursue research projects under the mentorship of esteemed scientists.
- **Lab:** Chromosome Biology Lab (CBL)
- **Mentor:** Dr. Kundan Sengupta, Principle Investigator

Teaching Assistant | Ashoka University

- **Duration:** May 2025 - June 2025
- **Program:** Lodha Genius Program

Research Intern | Ashoka University

- **Duration:** June 2025 - Present
- **Lab:** Evolutionary Immunology Lab
- **Mentor:** Dr. Imroze Khan, Principle Investigator
- **Work:** I am currently working under the guidance of a PhD student. The broad project looks at dual selection pressures of heat and infection on *Drosophila melanogaster* populations, and how their immune responses, pathways and other life history traits evolve as a result.

Biology Student Representative | Ashoka University

- **Duration:** May 2026 - May 2027

PORTFOLIO

NIUS Biology Camp

- **Location & Date:** Homi Bhabha Centre for Science Education, TIFR in November 2024.
- **Selection & Activities:** Selected to attend the Biology Camp organized by the National Initiative of Undergraduate Science in Mumbai, where we had the opportunity to conduct various experiments in the lab. We were later divided into groups, assigned specific inquiries, and tasked with exploring them through experimentation and literature reviews.

AWARDS

- **Wg Cdr Suhas Clement Solomon Award for Extraordinary Achievement:** December 2019, Vidya Valley School
- **National Silver Medal, Taekwondo:** August 2019, Gujarat, India.
- **Black Belt, Taekwondo:** April 2019, Fighters Taekwondo Academy.